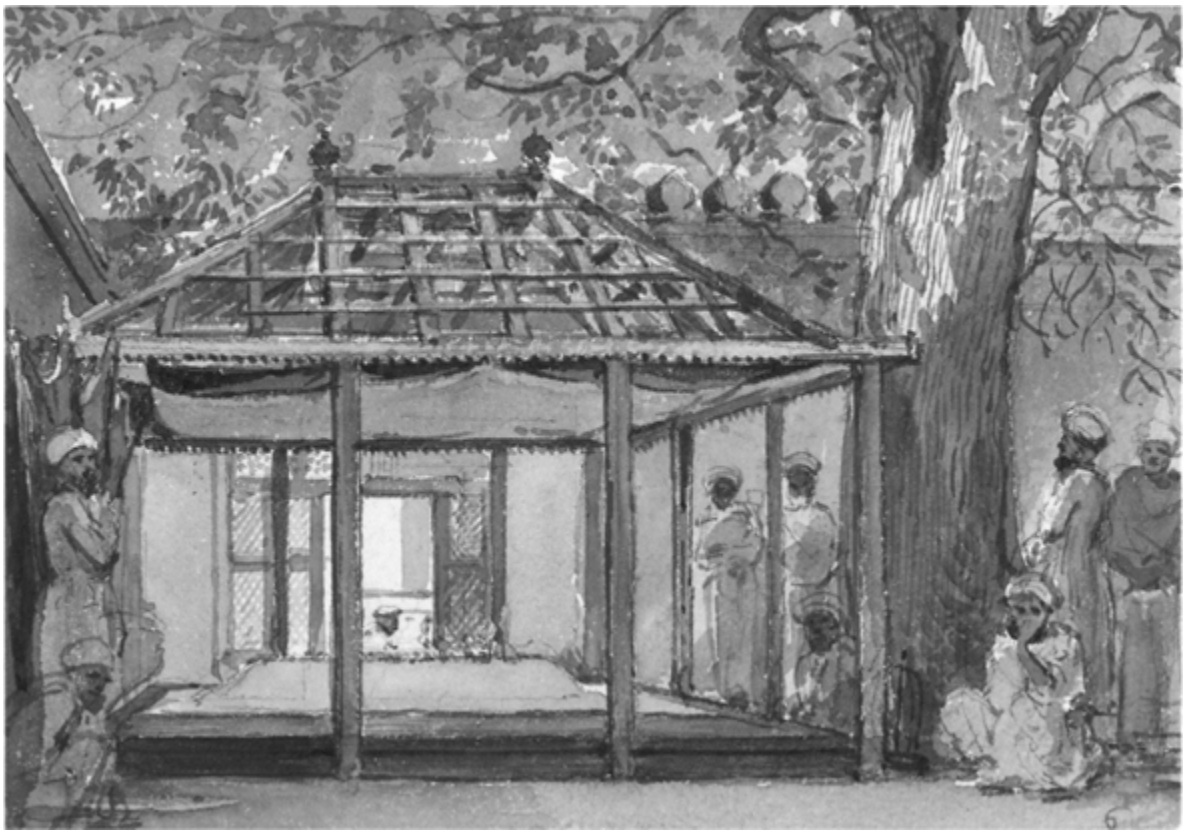


The unadorned tomb of Emperor Aurangzeb at Khuldabad, as drawn by the artist William Carpenter in 1850.

The *Fatawa-e-Alamgiri* conferred legitimacy on Aurangzeb's efforts to bring his Muslim subjects into line, first by crushing the deviant Shia kingdoms of Bijapur and Golconda, outlawing *ziyarat* – the popular custom of venerating the graves of Sufi saints – and banning alcohol, music, gambling, prostitution, fireworks and other corrupt practices. Although he spent the last twenty-five years of his life in hugely expensive and ultimately fruitless military campaigns to subjugate and hold the Deccan, he himself lived a life of increasing saintliness, shunning all fripperies in favour of the study of the Holy Koran, making copies of the same in his own hand and embroidering prayer caps for sale in the bazaar.

But it has to be said that in seeking to enforce his sharia Aurangzeb made life harder for India's majority *dhimmi*